Article | 19 August 2026

RATES SPARK

Rates Spark: The Treasury's plan for the back end

It s clear that the US Treasury is ready to place a limit to the upside for longer-dated yields. The impact of the increased buybacks is not so much on the doubling of them in long dates, but more so on the implied reality that they could be doubled again, and again if needed. But given what we have now, and until then, upward pressure on long yields will remain

With the US Treasury doubling the buybacks of long-dated bonds, there is the possibility they could do it again and again

As noted here, the Treasury's decision to increase buybacks in longer durations smacks of discomfort with the sell-off seen in longer tenor Treasury securities of late. It's been impactful, with the 10-30-year yields down 5-10bp to begin with. The official genesis of the buyback programme, back in May 2024, was to bolster liquidity, and indeed, that was the rationale employed to explain away the announced doubling of buyback sizes in the 10yr to 30yr maturities. If we annualise the quarterly rhythm, that nets an additional US$18bn of buybacks through these tenors. That stretches the buyback programme from US$38bn to US$56bn (of which US$36bn in the 10-30 yrs). On top of that, there is US$25bn in the 1–2 year area for cash management purposes. While the entire buyback programme is actually less in size than one regular 2yr auction event, it's still chunky.

We've also made the point that these buybacks need to be subsequently re-financed. And they do. However, the important nuance here is that for any given steady-state coupon issuance rhythm (which we've had and are likely to continue to have), any additional buybacks must, by definition, be financed through extra bills issuance (as bills are the variable that the Treasury must deploy with on a fixed bond issuance programme). This morphs the impact of the additional buybacks into a structural impact on long-dated bonds outstanding, as they effectually get replaced by rolling bills issuance. It's a zero-sum game from the Treasuries perspective, but from the markets' perspective, it adds to bills issuance, and has a bigger effect through lower long-duration net issuance.

We'd maintain the view that this move is unlikely on its own to change the trajectory for long-end yields. It does mute it though. And moreover, it reminds the market that the Treasury could double the long tenor buyback sizes again, and again if needed. That's the real kicker from this move: the anticipation for more should long-dated yields decide to morph higher again in an overly sinister fashion in the days and weeks and months ahead. Given that, we'd continue to identify upward pressure on long-end yields as a dominant factor that the market will need to deal with. But muted it absolutely is.

Note that this is not quantitative easing. It is long-end buying by the Treasury, effectively financed through buying more bills. As a stand-alone factor, it places a flattening impulse on the curve, thus muting the net steepening that we continue to anticipate. We're still of the opinion that the 10yr yield has a risk factor move in it to the 4.75% to 5% zone. And for now, it's unlikely to get much below 4.5%, but one thing has become more clear from this is any move above 5% (or even the material threat thereof), would likely be actively resisted/prevented by the US Treasury Department.

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Disclaimer

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Stablecoins 101: Uncertain growth but the stakes are high

Stablecoins saw significant growth in 2025, drawing attention from issuers and regulators alike. Still, their long-term prospects remain uncertain. In the first article of our new series, we explore what stablecoins are, what could drive adoption, and why their future matters

Despite a sharp expansion, stablecoins now account for only about 7% of the broader crypto market

Executive summary

Stablecoins have seen significant growth over the past few years, reaching nearly US$300bn in market capitalisation at the end of 2025. This rapid expansion has come with heightened attention from both regulators and potential issuers. However, the future of the crypto asset remains uncertain as further growth depends on whether it can develop beyond the crypto-landscape and expand into the broader payment world.

In our view, part of the path to becoming a broadly adopted instrument depends on the presence of a regulatory framework and interoperability with existing payment systems. However, estimating the future growth of stablecoins is difficult, as it requires predicting their relative attractiveness compared with alternative payment systems such as central bank digital currencies and tokenised deposits in a rapidly evolving

market.

While the jury is still out on how widely stablecoins could be adopted, it is important to consider a scenario in which uptake becomes significant, as this could have serious implications for financial stability, the banking sector, emerging markets, and monetary policy.

Despite the growing attention, many questions remain about what stablecoins are, how they work, and what role they could ultimately play in the financial system. In this piece, we explain the fundamentals of stablecoins, review recent market and regulatory developments, and explore the factors that could shape their future adoption. While the market is evolving quickly, their long-term prospects remain highly uncertain. Their eventual role in payments and savings will depend not only on regulation but also on whether they can compete with existing and emerging forms of digital money. In future publications, we will examine the implications of broader stablecoin adoption in more detail.

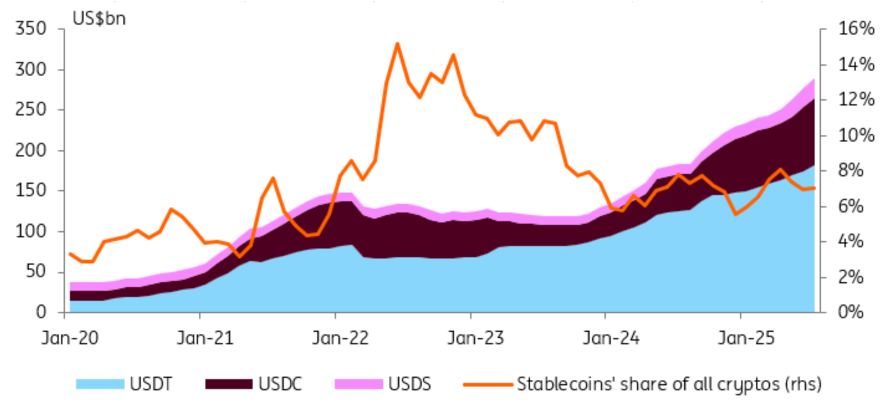
What are stablecoins?

Stablecoins are crypto assets issued by private institutions that promise a stable nominal value in a given currency, commodity or pool of assets. They are not issued or backed by a government or central authority but rather by a private institution and secured by segregated reserves. The crypto asset is issued on a Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) (i.e. a blockchain) with three existing types of pegging mechanisms:

1. **Fiat-collateralised** stablecoins: backed 1:1 by reserves of cash or liquid assets. These are the most common and utilised type of stablecoin, currently representing over 90% of all stablecoins. We will focus on these in this piece.
2. **Crypto-collateralised** stablecoins: backed by over-collateralised crypto assets. The issuance of these stablecoins tends to be restricted by regulations such as the EU's Markets in Crypto-Assets Regulation (MiCAR).
3. **Algorithmic** stablecoins: not backed by real assets, but the peg to the chosen currency is maintained by a dynamic adjustment of the token's supply using algorithms or "smart contracts". Following the crash of the Terra project in 2022, algorithmic stablecoins now represent only a fraction of all stablecoins.

The total market capitalisation of stablecoins has surpassed US$300bn globally, 99% of which is USD-pegged tokens. While still dwarfed by bank deposits, the rapid growth of the sector over the past five years (up by $250bn) has drawn considerable attention. Despite the sharp expansion, though, stablecoins now account for only about 7% of the broader crypto market, a decline from their 2022 peak, as the market capitalisation of other cryptocurrencies has grown even faster.

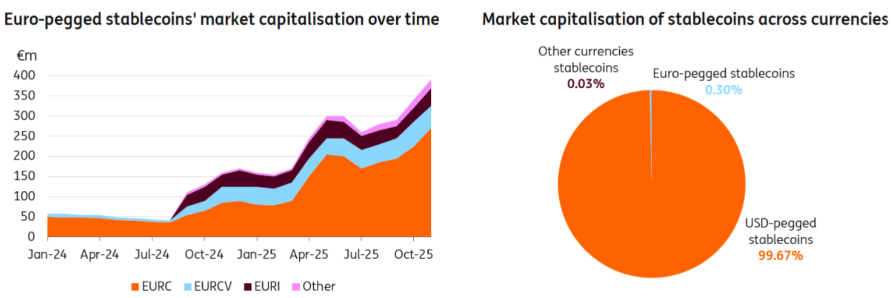
Selected stablecoins' market capitalisation over time & share of all cryptocurrencies



Source: ING Research, IMF / USDT = Tether, USDC = Circle, USDS = Sky Protocol

Euro-pegged stablecoins still only represent a fraction of all stablecoins in use, but their market capitalisation grew from €50m in early 2024 to nearly €400m at the end of 2025. Euro stablecoins remain in their infancy, accounting for only about 0.3% of the global stablecoin market despite recent progress.

Euro-pegged stablecoins remain at a nascent stage



Source: ING Research, ECB / EURC = Euro Circle, EURCV = Coinvertible, EURI = Eurite

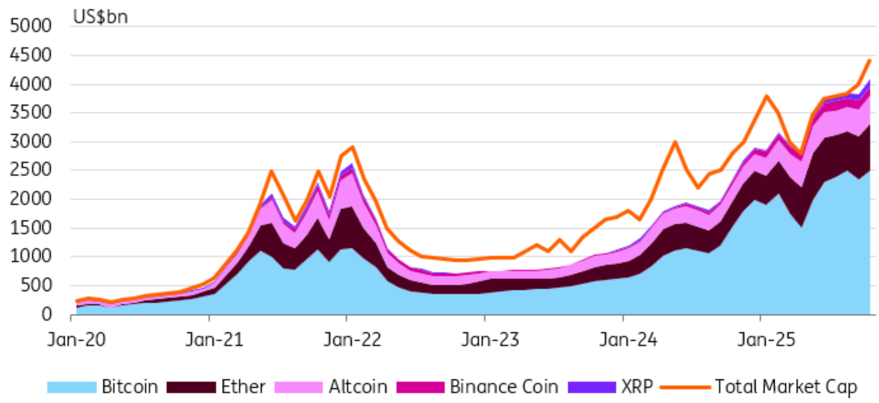
Available data shows that the use of stablecoins remains limited in the larger frame of global payments. Yet the sector's very rapid development over the past years suggests that could change. The new digital currency is forecast to grow exponentially, reaching anywhere between $900bn and $4.2tr by 2030. The wide variation in projections underscores just how hard it is to forecast the trajectory of stablecoins over the coming years. Indeed, **stablecoins' growth will depend on several factors: the regulation in place, interoperability with existing payment systems and, importantly, their use cases and relative attractiveness versus other payment systems (new or existing)**. The next section delves into other technologies that could influence the growth (or lack thereof) of stablecoins.

How do stablecoins differ from other digital & crypto currencies?

Unbacked cryptocurrencies

Stablecoins are a form of crypto asset, but they differ from other cryptocurrencies by holding segregated reserves designed to maintain a one-to-one value with a chosen reference currency. This is not the case for “real” cryptocurrencies that are also issued and transferred using Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT) but not backed by liquid assets. These unbacked cryptocurrencies are, therefore, much more volatile and used mainly for investment and speculative purposes. Taken together, cryptocurrencies’ market capitalisation reached nearly $4500bn at the end of 2025, about three times the level in early 2024.

Selected cryptocurrencies market capitalisation over time



Source: ING Research, IMF

Beyond stablecoins and unbacked cryptocurrencies, a new wave of digital currencies is gaining traction among both prospective issuers and regulators.

Tokenised assets

Tokenised assets are digital representations of real-world assets on a distributed ledger infrastructure. A wide range of underlying assets can be tokenised, including securities, bank deposits, and real estate.

Tokenisation is increasingly being explored for bank deposits, where the deposit itself is represented, stored, and issued on a DLT. Each token corresponds to a direct claim on a regulated commercial bank and remains on that bank’s balance sheet. Unlike stablecoins, tokenised deposits do not circulate as bearer instruments but are tied to identified account holders.

The usage of tokenised deposits currently remains limited and mostly experimental. However, tokenised deposits can modernise payment and settlement infrastructures, as well as intragroup liquidity management. They promise faster settlement (near-instant, in fact), 24/7 transactions, programmability, and lower operational frictions (reducing reliance on multiple intermediaries). Tokenised deposits also offer regulatory advantages, as they remain fully within the existing supervisory framework; the underlying assets stay on commercial banks' balance sheets, preserving the same oversight and prudential standards applied to traditional deposits.

Central Bank Digital Currencies

Central Bank Digital Currencies (CBDCs) are digital forms of money that allow users to pay each other using a direct claim on the central bank. In other words, it aims to reinvent central bank money (cash and coins) in a digital form. CBDCs are often compared and opposed to stablecoins, but the main difference is their direct claim to the central bank. They are issued and maintained by the central authority, often but not systematically using DLTs.

CBDCs can be built for retail or wholesale use (for interbank settlements and large-value transfers). Only a few CBDCs are currently in use in the world (Bahamas, Jamaica, Nigeria and China with a large-scale pilot). But over 100 countries have projects to develop their own digital currency. This includes the EU, which is currently developing its own retail CBDC (the digital euro) and aiming for a 2029 launch. Read more on this in our piece *The digital euro is making progress, European banks should pay attention*.

In addition to the digital euro, the EU is looking at developing a wholesale DLT settlement strategy. The near-term project 'Pontes' will leverage existing T2 infrastructure and provide immediate central bank money settlement. It's expected to be launched in 3Q 2026. The European Central Bank also plans a full DLT-based wholesale CBDC ecosystem under the 'Appia' initiative, with a blueprint expected in 2028.

To summarise the four digital currencies discussed, the table below highlights the key differences across their main attributes.

Currencies comparison table

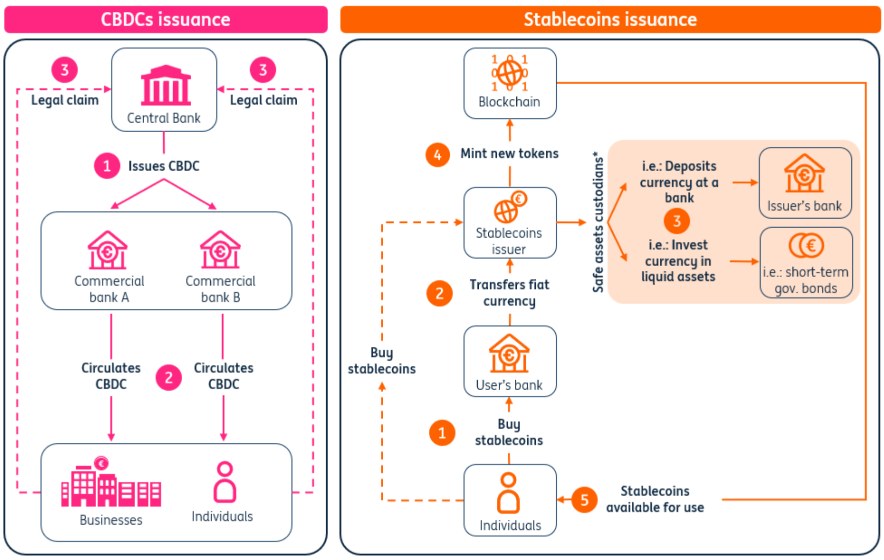
	Stablecoins	CBDCs	'Real' cryptos	Tokenised deposits	Bank deposits	Cash
Digital	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Public	No	Yes	No	No	No	Yes
Blockchain use	Yes	Possible	Yes	Yes	No	No
Programmable	Yes	Possible	Yes	Yes	Possible	No
Use without intermediaries	Yes	Possible	Yes	No	No	Yes
Large price volatility	Limited by pegging mechanism	No	Yes	No	No	No
Means of payment role	Yes	Yes	Not in the wider economy	Yes	Yes	Yes
Unit of account role (used for invoicing)	Yes	Yes	Not in the wider economy	Yes	Yes	Yes
Store of value role	Potential, especially if remuneration allowed	Not if implementation of holding limits	No	Linked to real-world bank deposits	Yes	Yes
Regulation	Fragmented	National	Fragmented	Yes	Yes	Yes

Possible No Yes

Source: ING Research

Both stablecoins and CBDCs aim to create a more digital and efficient means of payment, yet they are often portrayed as competing alternatives. Despite this, the two forms of digital money differ significantly. Their key differences can be illustrated through their issuance models, shown in the flowchart below.

CBDCs versus stablecoins issuance flow



Source: ING Research *examples of safe asset custodians, can vary depending on the regulation in place

The approach to stablecoins and CBDCs varies across the globe, with notable differences between the US and Europe. The transatlantic divide became increasingly apparent in the summer of 2025, when the US moved to support dollar-backed stablecoins while prohibiting the issuance of a CBDC. Europe has taken a different approach, arguing that a CBDC, the digital euro, would enhance regulatory oversight through issuance and supervision by the European Central Bank.

Given the starkly different political approaches across jurisdictions, stablecoins are likely to evolve as primarily domestic or regional instruments, a dynamic that could shape and, potentially, constrain their overall growth potential.

For stablecoins to become systemically important, their use needs to extend beyond the crypto ecosystem into the broader, global, payments world. However, political positions are already signalling resistance to a global (dollar-pegged) stablecoin, with policymakers instead encouraging the development of multiple domestic stablecoins denominated in local currencies.

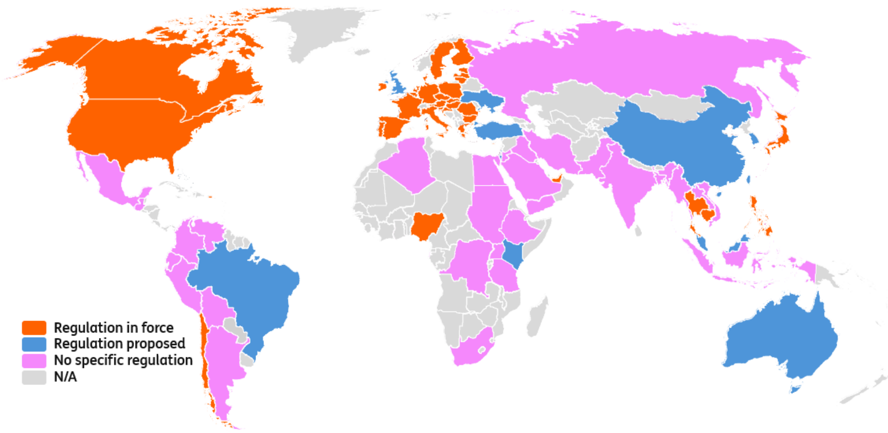
The absence of regulatory harmonisation reinforces this trend. Stablecoin issuers must adapt to each jurisdiction's rules, limiting cross-border scalability and undermining the emergence of a single dominant global stablecoin. The next section outlines the regulatory divergences across the US, EU, and UK.

Large regulatory differences and crucial remuneration uncertainty

Currently, 12 countries have stablecoin regulations in force, and another 10 have proposed texts that are not yet approved. The strongest stance against the issuance of stablecoins comes from China, where they're banned. This partly stems from the government's push for its CBDC; stablecoins are therefore viewed as direct competition.

The main laws are in place in the trading hubs, while other markets still lack specific stablecoin and crypto asset regulations. Despite recent developments at the national or regional level, there's an absence of international harmonisation and coordination on the topic.

Distribution of current stablecoin regulations worldwide



Source: ING Research, Visual capitalist

Because of the lack of international harmonisation on stablecoin oversight, existing regulatory frameworks diverge in several ways. The most important difference concerns the management of the safe assets. Indeed, issuers face various types and levels of restrictions for the segregated reserves. This could influence stablecoins' potential impact on the financial system.

Under US regulation (GENIUS Act), issuers must hold at least $1 of permitted reserves for every $1 of stablecoins issued. Permitted reserves include (but are not exclusively) cash, deposits held at commercial banks, short-dated treasury bills and other similar government-issued assets approved by regulators. The absence of specific limits or thresholds on each of these options gives USD-stablecoin issuers a relatively large degree of freedom to allocate their reserves.

This isn't replicated in the European legislation. MiCAR sets stricter requirements for E-Money institute issuers. These institutions (if systemic) are required to hold at least 60% of the safe assets as commercial banks' deposits (30% if non-systemic issuers). They're allowed to hold 40% of their reserves in liquid government bonds (70% if non-systemic issuers).

While the UK is still drafting its final stablecoin regulatory framework, the latest proposal includes restrictions on reserve investments. For systemic issuers, the Bank of England proposes prohibiting the use of commercial bank deposits and requiring that at least 30% of backing assets be held as non‑remunerated central bank deposits. The remaining 70% could be invested in short‑term government debt. The central bank argues that allowing commercial bank deposits as backing could introduce financial, operational, and contagion risks that could amplify a stress across the sector. Additionally, the UK is the first country to propose a temporary issuance guardrail for systemic issuers, limiting the amount of stablecoins issued to £40bn per issuer for an unspecified temporary period.

While myriad other divergences exist, we also note one convergence between the US, EU and UK regulatory frameworks: the ban on remuneration distribution. All three regimes prohibit stablecoin issuers from paying interest to holders. In the US, where broader crypto market legislation is still under negotiation, this restriction is heavily debated and could ultimately be revised.

Interest payments by stablecoin issuers remain prohibited in most jurisdictions. This restriction is central to the regulatory architecture, as it directly shapes stablecoins' appeal as a store of value and influences both adoption dynamics and its potential footprint in the broader financial system.

The table below summarises the main differences between the three regulatory frameworks. Read more on the various regulatory frameworks in the footnotes.

Summary of the US, EU and UK stablecoins regulatory frameworks

			US[1] Genius Act	EU MiCAR		UK[2] Regulation	
				E-money institute	Credit institution	Non-systemic issuers	Systemic issuers
1.	**Access to central bank**, lender of last resort		**Case-by-case** Fed decision	**Forbidden**	**No restrictions**		Bank of England **considering** backstop facility
2.	**Asset investment policy**	**Central Bank deposit**	**Case-by-case** Fed decision	**Forbidden**	**Allowed**	**Allowed**	**Required** i) ≥30% of assets; ii) unremunerated
		Commercial bank deposit	**Allowed** upper limit to be specified	**Required** ≥60% of assets (≥30% if non-systemic)	**Allowed**	**Allowed**	**Forbidden**
		Government bonds	**Allowed** ≤3m maturity	**Allowed** <40% of assets (<70% if non-systemic)	**Allowed**	**Allowed**	**Allowed** <70% of assets
3.	**Stablecoins remuneration**		**Forbidden** for issuer only	**Forbidden** for issuer and crypto-asset service providers (CASP)	**Forbidden** for issuer and CASP	**Forbidden** for issuer	**Forbidden** for issuer
4.	**Issuance guardrail**		None	None	None	N/A	Temporary £40bn

Source: ING Research, Fed, European Commission, BoE

1 US has three license levels: for a) bank and b) non-banks at federal level, and c) one at state level for smaller institutions. 2 Proposed UK-regime based on June 2026 proposal in Bank of England consultation

...driving the key uncertainty on stablecoins' uptake

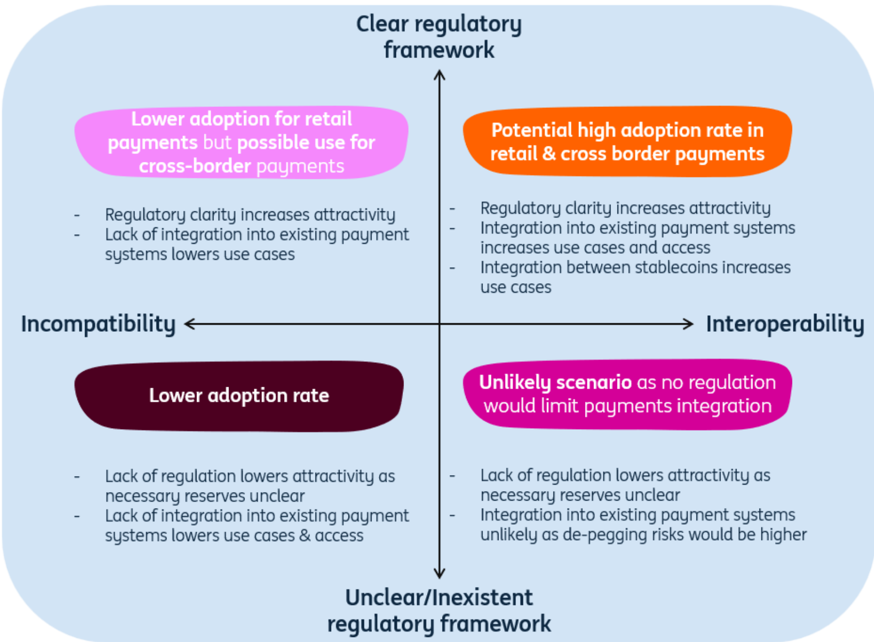
Stablecoins' rapid growth over the past few years, in association with the lack of regulation, has raised concern for central banks across the world. Depending on future growth and use cases, stablecoins could have a significant impact on financial stability. For this to materialise, stablecoin use and adoption would have to go beyond the niche crypto-ecosystem and extend to the payment landscape.

While stablecoins have grown significantly over the years, they are not currently "broadly adopted". Currently, there's no set threshold determining what would constitute this broad adoption. Furthermore, the development of the crypto asset over the next few years remains unclear. In our view, the adoption uptake would depend on its use for two things:

- Payments
- As a store of value

Starting with the use of stablecoins in payments, there are three main variables. The first two factors are the presence of a regulatory framework and the degree of interoperability between stablecoins and existing payment systems. Mapping these variables produces a quadrant that illustrates four potential development paths for stablecoins.

Potential development of stablecoins in retail payments



Source: ING Research

A scenario with both a clear regulatory framework and full integration of stablecoins into existing payment systems would provide fertile ground for meaningful adoption in payments. However, the extent of such uptake depends on the third variable: the attractiveness of other payment systems (new and existing ones).

The existence and development of alternatives such as tokenised deposits and central bank digital currencies might limit the relative attractiveness of stablecoins. Even though payment systems in Europe remain relatively cheap and fast, that experience is far from universal internationally. For regions where payments are costly and slow, introducing new technologies such as tokenisation into existing systems could allow them to rapidly close the gap with the advantages stablecoins offer, and potentially emerge as direct competitors to the crypto asset.

There is also a potential political push toward adopting central bank digital currencies, a dynamic relevant not only for jurisdictions with high payment costs but for the EU as well. The digital euro has become a central topic in the 'strategic payment autonomy' discussion and could directly compete with stablecoins for day-to-day payment use.

When it comes to the use of stablecoins as a store of value, a significant uptake would depend on two points:

- Whether direct remuneration by stablecoin issuers is allowed. The current ban on direct remuneration in major jurisdictions does little to support the use of stablecoins as deposit-like instruments, except in countries where real interest rates are negative. However, we can't exclude regulatory changes in coming years, especially as the topic is currently under discussion in the US with the upcoming Clarity Act. Read more on this in our regulatory footnotes below.
- The interest rate level paid on alternative deposit accounts (such as traditional bank deposits), as stablecoins could become more of a competitor to traditional deposit accounts in an environment where interest rates are zero or close to zero (which has been the case in the EU in recent years and is still the case in the US).

Only if, and with the right combination of these factors, could we foresee the adoption of stablecoins growing significantly to become broadly adopted. Yet, at present, it remains difficult to estimate the direction the crypto asset will follow in the years ahead.

Potential implications of stablecoins

Although stablecoins are not yet widely adopted and their future trajectory remains hard to pin down, our forthcoming articles will explore a scenario in which they scale enough to become a meaningful payment system. We see this as a necessary exercise: broad stablecoin adoption could carry significant and far-reaching implications for the financial system – spanning the banking sector, emerging market stability, safe asset demand, monetary policy transmission, and even geopolitical and cyber-risk dynamics.

Indeed, research has found that upon broad adoption, stablecoins could drive significant changes in banks' funding. Depending on the required reserves, this could translate into either a net drop in retail deposits or a switch from retail into wholesale deposits (as MiCAR requires stablecoin issuers to hold part of the reserves in EU commercial banks). Overall, it could make banks' funding structure more volatile as wholesale deposits are known to be less steady funding sources than retail ones (which are rarely moved across institutions). Also, wholesale deposits are costlier to hold for banks as the regulation imposes higher capital requirements, reflecting their higher volatility and general risk level.

Stablecoins could also have implications in emerging markets through currency substitution. It could amplify depreciation pressures under stress episodes by lowering friction around moving local currency into USD stablecoins. Countries with weak monetary credibility (i.e. high inflation, low interest rates) make stablecoins an attractive store of value and payment means, even outside stress episodes. The outflow to stablecoins could further undermine monetary policy transmission.

USD stablecoins also have the potential to boost demand for short-term US treasuries as issuers look for safe asset reserves. In principle, quick changes in transaction-driven demand could then amplify volatility in rates under a stress scenario. The proliferation of stablecoins (regardless of the currency) may also shift the composition of the overall monetary base with an asset reallocation from bank deposits into treasury/government bonds. This means potentially weaker monetary policy transmission through both the credit and interest rate channels.

While all these points remain theoretical implications of stablecoins, regulators are increasingly concerned and estimates on those impacts are developing. In future reports, we aim to contribute to the growing body of literature on this subject by diving deeper into each of these potential implications, seriously considering a scenario where stablecoins become a broadly adopted payment system.

Stablecoins are growing but the jury is still out on how big they'll get

Over the last few years, the market capitalisation of stablecoins has grown significantly, attracting the attention of both potential issuers and regulators across the globe. However, when it comes to the development of the crypto asset, it remains difficult to estimate an exact path. In our view, the growth of stablecoins in the coming years could be limited or strong depending on their uptake in both payments and as a store of value. Part of this growth to become a “broadly adopted” instrument depends on the existence of a regulatory framework and the interoperability with existing payment systems. The difficulty in estimating stablecoin growth comes from predicting the relative attractiveness versus alternative payment systems (new or old) as the sector quickly evolves.

It's important to consider a scenario where the use of stablecoins increases significantly, as this could have serious implications for financial stability, the banking sector, and emerging markets, as well as monetary policy. Therefore, in our upcoming series of articles, we will dive into potential impacts in more depth, starting with the implications of “broadly adopted” stablecoins for financial institutions.

Regulatory footnotes

The United States' GENIUS Act

Adopted in July 2025, the Guiding and Establishing National Innovation for US Stablecoins Act (GENIUS Act) establishes a regime to regulate US payment stablecoins. Despite the enforcement starting in January 2027, the mere adoption of the GENIUS Act had an immediate effect on USD-denominated stablecoins, with net stablecoin creation growing from about $10bn in 2Q25 (before the regulation) to over $45bn in 3Q25, a 324% increase in just a couple of months.

The regulation permits stablecoins to be issued by banks, credit unions and certain non-bank entities (although non-bank issuers are limited to financial firms unless the Stablecoin Certification Review Committee (SCRC) unanimously determines that they do not pose a risk to the banking or financial system).

Issuers face tailored capital, liquidity, and risk management rules but are not subject to the regulatory capital standards for "traditional" banks. Banks issuing stablecoins are regulated by the Federal Reserve, while non-banks fall under the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency (OCC) oversight.

Aside from permitted issuers, the GENIUS Act also clarifies stablecoin requirements. I**ssuers must hold at least $1 of permitted reserves for every $1 of stablecoins issued**. Permitted reserves include (but are not limited to) USD cash, deposits held at commercial banks, short-dated treasury bills and other similar government-issued assets approved by regulators.

Additionally, issuers of the digital currency must comply with several transparency and reporting requirements, including regular reporting on the reserve composition, and must run audits by public accounting firms. They are required to disclose the redemption procedures and comply with the US Bank Secrecy Act as well as tailored Anti-Money Laundering and Counter-Terrorism Financing (AML/CTF) rules.

The GENIUS Act also currently prohibits issuers from paying interest to stablecoin holders. However, the topic is open to discussion in the US as the proposed CLARITY Act (which aims to clarify the broader crypto asset regulatory landscape) could include the possibility for stablecoin issuers to distribute customer rewards.

The EU's Markets in Crypto-Assets Regulation (MiCAR)

MiCAR was adopted in 2023 and covers a wide range of crypto assets. The stablecoin rules gradually came into force through the end of 2024. They apply to both issuers and entities offering trading, custody, exchange and advisory on crypto assets. **MiCAR classifies crypto assets in three categories**:

- **Asset-Referenced Tokens** (ARTs): stablecoins backed by a basket of assets such as fiat currencies or commodities
- **E-Money Tokens** (EMTs): stablecoins pegged to a single fiat currency
- **Other crypto assets:** including decentralised cryptocurrencies and other tokens (not falling into the first two categories)

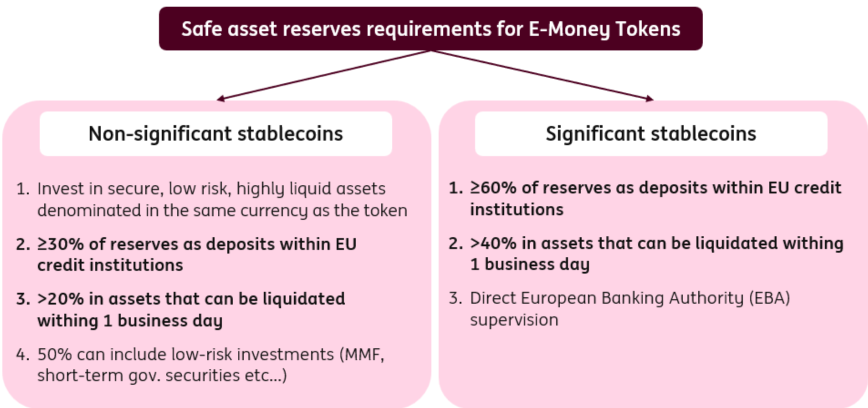
The regulation clarifies which entities are allowed to issue crypto assets in the Union, namely credit institutions and Authorised Electronic Money Institutions (EMIs). In addition, the EU differentiates cryptocurrencies by their size, including specific requirements for the largest assets**.**

Stablecoins are considered significant when (but not only):

- The **number of holders** is larger than **10m**
- The **value of the token** issued (market capitalisation or size of the reserve of assets) is higher than **€5bn**
- The **average number and transaction value per day** are higher than **2.5m and €0.5bn,** respectively

Under MiCAR, stablecoin issuers are required to have a legal entity established in the EU. The regulation sets out a list of requirements for stablecoins issued in the EU, starting with the prohibition on the distribution of interest on the tokens. It also establishes requirements for stablecoin reserves. For E‑Money Tokens (EMTs) specifically, regulatory requirements differ depending on whether the issuer is classified as significant or not. The graph below summarises the safe assets requirements depending on the size of the stablecoin issuer.

MiCAR safe asset requirements per stablecoin issuer type



Source: ING Research, MiCA Regulation

Additionally, all issuers of stablecoins in the EU are subject to transparency and reporting requirements, including the publication of whitepapers on the token's functionality, risk and technology. Issuers must run quarterly stress testing and comply with the Union's AML/CTF rules.

The UK's upcoming regulation

In June 2026, the Bank of England published a policy statement and draft rules for systemic stablecoin issuers. The BoE's approach to stablecoin regulation varies from existing frameworks as it plans to ban systemic issuers from holding part of their reserves with commercial banks.

The central bank argues that this decision is warranted by the financial, operational, and contagion risks that could arise between stablecoins and the broader financial system during periods of stress. This stance contrasts with the EU stablecoin regulation that requires issuers to hold part of their reserves as commercial bank deposits.

Issuers would therefore be required to hold at least 30% of the reserves in unremunerated BoE deposits and the remaining 70% in short-term UK government debt securities with a residual maturity of up to six months.

The draft rule sets aside the individual holding limit requirement announced previously and instead proposes a temporary issuance guardrail to mitigate risks to credit provision. Each systemic stablecoin issuer will be subject to an initial maximum issuance of £40bn. This limit would be reviewed, loosened and ultimately removed; the BoE doesn't include a timeline for such phasing out. If enforced as such, the UK would be the first country to officially regulate the amount of stablecoins issued, even on a temporary basis.

The proposal plans to require systemic stablecoin issuers to conduct an overall risk assessment to identify, monitor and mitigate risks. Additionally, it sets minimum capital requirements composed of six months of the issuer's relevant operating expenses or the cost of executing its recovery plan. It also requires notifying the central bank when its capital falls below 110% of the minimum requirements.

The Bank of England plans to install a statutory trust mechanism comprising two trusts: one to protect coinholders' interests and the other to cover the costs of returning value to them. Stablecoin issuers will thus be required to segregate the assets used for reserves and appoint third-party custodians to hold these. The proposal also includes a prohibition on the payment of interest and income to coinholders.

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Disclaimer

Article | 20 August 2026 FX

FX Daily: Introducing the Bessent Put in Treasuries

For many years, the market spoke of a Greenspan Put in equity markets, where investors were protected from much lower stock prices by the assumption that the Fed would cut rates. Yesterday s intervention in the Treasury market suggests the recent rise in longer-dated yields has touched a raw nerve. Risk assets are enjoying this more activist US Treasury

Washington's intervention in the bond market is welcomed by risk assets and is weighing on the dollar

USD: Investors greet a more interventionist Treasury

While increasing liquidity buy-back operations by $2bn might seem like rearranging deckchairs on the Titanic given the US national debt of $40tr, yesterday's intervention by the US Treasury has been warmly greeted by investors around the world. As ING's Padhraic Garvey writes, this unscheduled announcement tells us the Treasury's displeasure with the recent sell-off at the long end of the bond market. Clearly, a more structural solution such as fiscal consolidation is required for a more sustainable recovery in the bond market, but news that the US Treasury is going to be more vigilant about the long end has been welcomed.

The 10bp drop in longer-dated US yields has lifted equities and seen the dollar soften, especially against high-beta currencies such as the Norwegian krone, New Zealand dollar and Swedish krona. The Bessent Put – or someone to watch over the US Treasury market – reduces one of the key threats to risk assets this summer and should see carry trade strategies remaining popular.

At the same time, the minutes of the July FOMC meeting were not particularly hawkish and short-dated US yields actually fell 5bp after the release. This all leaves the dollar in a flat/lower pattern consistent with a 'Risk-on, Dollar-off' investment environment – EMFX typically does well at times like these.

For today, the US data calendar is light, and we will hear from two Federal Reserve hawks: Mary Daly, who voted for a hike in July, and Alberto Musalem, a non-voter.

DXY unexpectedly broke down from its 99.40-100.00 range yesterday and can probably drift lower to 98.65. The next stop would be 98.00 should risk assets build another leg higher on this more activist US Treasury.

Chris Turner

EUR: Pro-cyclical currencies get a boost

EUR/USD broke higher yesterday on the US Treasury news, which could usher in a slightly more encouraging, or at least stable, investment environment. Ever-higher natural gas prices in Europe remain a worry, but investors are thinking about another bearish dollar leg emerging, with EUR/USD playing its part.

Behind the scenes, foreigners are also buying a lot of eurozone debt and equities. Data released by the European Central Bank yesterday showed that foreigners have bought around €1.1tr of eurozone securities over the last 12 months. And June saw the largest ever monthly purchases of debt at €200bn. Thus, the bullish euro narrative of diversification away from the US remains present.

Yesterday's US intervention has brought EUR/USD close to our end-September target of 1.17. Resistance at 1.1700 may be a tough nut to crack in the short term, but if so, 1.1790 beckons. Support may be found as close as 1.1650/60. Also, a reminder that we consider European asset managers underhedged on their US investments.

Chris Turner

SEK: Riksbank unlikely to turn too hawkish

Sweden's Riksbank meets to discuss interest rate policy today. No change is expected to the 1.75% policy rate. There is no new Monetary Policy Report and therefore no new forecasts. This probably means that June's assumption of a rate hike towards the end of the year remains valid. The market prices a 25bp hike for the November meeting.

It is not clear that the Riksbank needs to sound a lot more hawkish today – and doing so would be a surprise given the September meeting is priced at just a 40% chance of a hike. While a pro-risk environment is good for the krona, its risk-adjusted carry is quite low by G10 standards, and we doubt it should lead the charge against a weaker dollar. Overall, we have a 10.90 EUR/SEK target for end-September, but doubt EUR/SEK needs to move much today.

Chris Turner

CNY: Authorities happy to allow a stronger yuan

USD/CNY continues to trade lower as authorities deliver lower fixings and the yuan participates in this mini-renaissance for Asian FX. We discussed the Korean won in this space yesterday. The onshore USD/CNY is trading at its lowest levels since February 2023 and looks intent to test the 6.69 area, which we see as the lower end of this year's trading range. Driving these yuan gains, we presume, are Chinese exporters who have found increasing confidence in the yuan while losing confidence in the dollar.

The move will be well appreciated by the US Treasury as part of the Mar-a-Lago mindset.

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Article | 20 August 2026 COMMODITIES DAILY

The Commodities Feed: Oil advances as US tightens pressure on Iran

Oil prices extended their rally amid growing concerns over tighter US sanctions on Iran

The EIA's latest weekly inventory report showed US commercial crude oil inventories rising for the third consecutive week, marking the highest level since May

Energy – EIA reports surprise increase in crude inventories

Oil extended its rally for a fifth consecutive day after US President Donald Trump announced measures to intensify economic pressure on Iran. ICE Brent climbed above $92/bbl, while NYMEX WTI traded above $86/bbl on Thursday morning, supported by concerns over tighter sanctions enforcement. Trump also warned of tougher economic penalties for entities supporting Iranian economic activities, signalling a further escalation in US efforts to isolate Iran.

The EIA's latest weekly inventory report showed US commercial crude oil inventories increased by 4.4m barrels to 428.8m barrels, marking a third consecutive weekly build and the highest level since May. This contrasted sharply with API's reported 328k barrel draw and market expectations for a 74k barrel decline. Meanwhile, the Strategic Petroleum Reserve fell by 5.3m barrels, leaving total US crude oil inventories down by a modest 0.9m barrels.

The commercial stock build was driven by higher domestic supply despite strong export demand and lower imports. Crude exports rose by 1.01m b/d week-on-week to 4.07m b/d, while imports fell by 746k b/d to 6.59m b/d. Refinery activity remained robust, with crude throughput increasing by 216k b/d and utilisation rates rising to 97.2%, close to seasonal highs. Strong refining margins continue to incentivise refiners to maximise run rates.

Refined product inventories showed a mixed picture. Gasoline stocks increased by 0.69m barrels to 209.4m barrels, while distillate inventories fell by 1.5m barrels to 105.6m barrels. The decline in distillate stocks was driven by lower imports and reduced domestic production, tightening supply in the US market. Middle distillate markets remain relatively tight, supported by resilient international demand and ongoing supply constraints across key exporting regions.

Metals – Copper squeeze eases as LME stocks rise

Tightness in the copper market eased after more than 35kt of metal was added to available LME inventories yesterday, following an increase of over 20kt in the previous session. The cash-to-three-month spread narrowed to a backwardation of $176/t, from as much as $545/t on Monday. However, continued tightness at the very front of the curve suggests the squeeze has not fully run its course. The market remains vulnerable after months of inventory outflows, driven partly by the diversion of metal to the US ahead of expected tariffs. We expect copper prices to remain supported by tight physical supply, although further inventory inflows could ease near-term pressure and trigger additional volatility.

Meanwhile, data from China's National Bureau of Statistics showed refined copper production rose 1.3% year-on-year to 1.3Mt in July, supported by higher sulphuric acid by-product prices, which boosted smelter margins and encouraged increased operating rates. Elsewhere in the base metals complex, lead output fell 7.3% YoY to 580kt, while zinc production edged down 0.8% YoY to 629kt over the same period.

The US and Canada are reportedly discussing cutting tariffs on certain Canadian aluminium and steel shipments to 25% from 50% as part of a tentative trade deal. Details remain under negotiation, including possible exemptions and product-specific rates.

The move would offer some relief to US aluminium consumers. Canada is the largest supplier of primary aluminium to the US, which remains heavily reliant on imports to meet demand. A lower tariff should put downward pressure on the US Midwest premium and reduce costs for downstream manufacturers, although tight global supply and uncertainty over the deal's scope may limit the decline. Canadian steel would also become more competitive in the US, potentially weighing on domestic steel prices.

Agriculture – White sugar premium hits multi-year high amid supply concerns

The white-to-raw sugar premium widened to around US$154/t, its highest level since March 2024, reflecting increasingly tight supply conditions. Both raw and white sugar prices strengthened after reports that India could cut or remove its 100% sugar import duty to boost domestic availability. Concerns over supply have intensified as monsoon rainfall during the June-September period is running 13% below average. White sugar has also outperformed raw sugar, supporting refining margins, amid weather-related declines in European beet sugar production.

In addition, disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz have constrained refining activity in the Middle East, while higher energy and freight costs have provided further support to white sugar prices.

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COMMODITIES DAILY

The Commodities Feed: Oil rises amid US-Iran conflict

Oil prices rose for a fourth consecutive session on Wednesday, supported by ongoing uncertainty surrounding the US-Iran standoff and the potential implications for shipping through the Strait of Hormuz

Energy – Oil inventory draws support prices

Oil prices extended gains for a fourth consecutive session on Wednesday as uncertainty over a resolution to the US-Iran conflict continued to support risk premiums. US President Donald Trump reiterated that no talks were underway with Tehran and signalled that additional sanctions could be announced this week. Reports of reduced vessel traffic through the Strait of Hormuz have also raised concerns over potential oil supply disruptions.

The oil market also drew support from a slightly bullish API inventory report. US crude inventories fell by 328k barrels last week, compared with market expectations for a 74k-barrel draw. Stocks at the WTI delivery hub in Cushing declined by 1.4m barrels. Product inventories were mixed, with gasoline stocks rising by 1.1m barrels while distillate inventories fell by 2.8m barrels. The more closely watched EIA inventory report is due later today.

US diesel crack spreads climbed above $100/bbl yesterday, reaching a record high as global refining constraints and supply disruptions tightened the market. Diesel cracks have more than doubled since the start of the US-Iran conflict and are up more than 20% month-to-date. Export restrictions from Russia, following repeated Ukrainian drone attacks on refineries, have reduced diesel availability, while disruptions affecting energy infrastructure elsewhere have added to concerns over supply and helped support prices.

Metals – Copper retreats as LME stocks jump

LME copper prices fell below $14,000/t yesterday, posting their sharpest decline since 23 July, as fresh deliveries into LME warehouses eased a prolonged supply squeeze. On-warrant copper inventories rose by 20,025 tonnes, the largest daily increase since 7 April, extending gains for a sixth consecutive session to 123,100 tonnes. Most of the inflows were directed to warehouses in Asia and the US.

The increase in stocks helped alleviate tightness after inventories had been depleted by strong shipments to the US, driven by tariff-related arbitrage opportunities. Reflecting the improved supply situation, the LME cash/3M copper spread narrowed to $248/t, while the tom-next spread also retreated after recently reaching levels last seen during the 2021 copper squeeze.

The latest COTR data showed speculators cut net long copper positions by 6,340 lots to 53,914 lots, ending a two-week streak of increases despite higher copper prices. In aluminium, money managers reduced net longs by 2,267 lots to 78,492 lots, largely driven by a 22,874-lot increase in gross short positions. Zinc net longs also declined, falling by 7,602 lots to 37,759 lots as of last Friday.

Agriculture – Sugar climbs on mounting supply concerns

Sugar prices extended their rally for a second consecutive session yesterday, with ICE No.11 raw sugar settling nearly 3.6% higher at its strongest level since May 2025. Gains were driven by reports that India is considering reducing or scrapping its 100% import duty to help replenish domestic supplies ahead of a seasonal increase in demand.

Sugar prices are now up more than 16% this month, supported by tightening global supplies. Meanwhile, speculative net long positions rose to 58,990 lots, the most bullish positioning since April 2025. Additional support has come from weather risks, with El Niño threatening sugar production across Asia, while above-average rainfall in Brazil has disrupted sugarcane processing, further tightening supply expectations.

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COMMODITIES, FOOD & AGRI

Could copper lose its tariff premium?

Copper has rallied sharply on expectations of US import tariffs, as traders rush metal into the US and physical markets tighten. With prices back near record highs, any policy disappointment could put that tariff premium to the test

Monthly US copper imports surged to a 12-year high of more than 200,000 tonnes in July ahead of potential tariffs

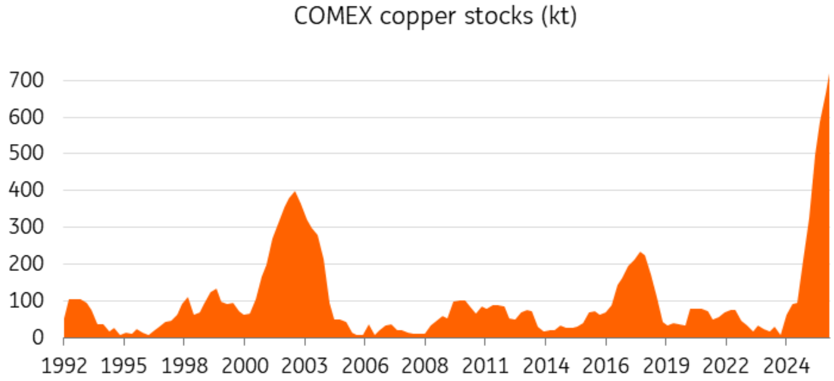
Copper is trading above $14,000/t, close to its record high. At the same time, LME inventories have fallen further, and the cash-to-three-month spread has moved deeper into backwardation, highlighting increasingly tight physical market conditions.

In our June note, What's next for US copper import tariffs?, we examined the possible policy outcomes. Since then, traders have continued to position for potential tariffs, with the impact becoming increasingly visible in trade flows, inventories and physical market indicators.

Tariff expectations remain a key market driver

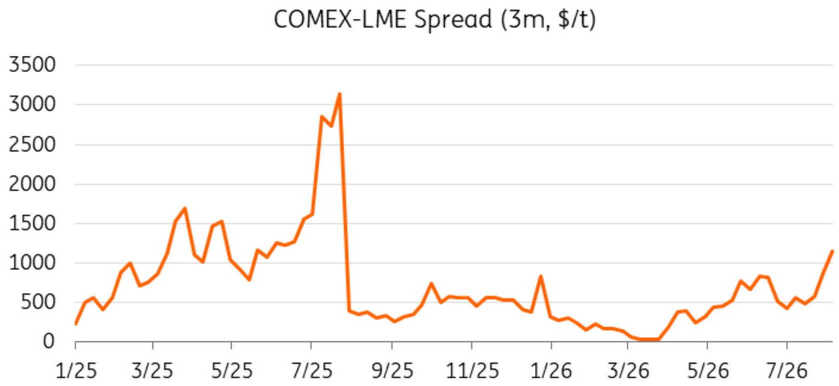
Copper shipments into the US have accelerated ahead of a potential tariff decision, pushing COMEX inventories to a record high. US copper imports exceeded 200,000 tonnes in July alone – the highest monthly level in at least 12 years.

COMEX inventories reach record highs



Source: COMEX, ING Research

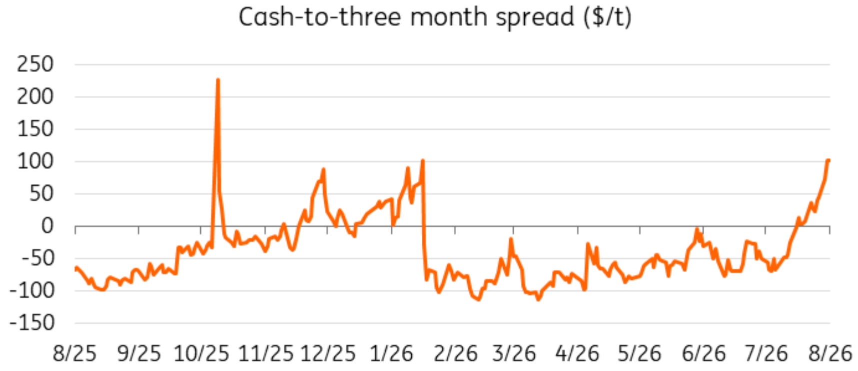
Wide COMEX-LME spread continues to attract copper into the US



Source: COMEX, LME, ING Research

At the same time, the London copper market is showing increasing signs of tightness. LME inventories have fallen to a five-month low, while the cash-to-three-month spread has widened to around $120/t backwardation – up from about $40 a week ago and the widest since October, pointing to a squeeze on short-term supplies.

Nearby copper market tightens



Source: LME, ING Research

LME inventories continue to decline

Source: LME, ING Research

Can tariff expectations continue to drive prices?

The recent rally is not solely tariff-driven, however.

Mine supply growth remains constrained, while low treatment charges continue to point to tight concentrate availability. Demand linked to electrification, power grid investment and AI infrastructure also remains supportive. We continue to expect the global refined copper market to record a deficit of around 35k tonnes in 2026.

Much of the recent rally reflects expectations that tariffs will be implemented broadly as expected. But if the final measures are delayed, narrower than expected or exempt refined copper, part of the recent rally could unwind. Stockpiling into the US would slow, inventory flows would begin to normalise, and some of the current tightness outside the US would ease. Any correction could be amplified if investors unwind positions built on tariff expectations.

The tariff decision is only part of the story

The prospect of US tariffs has already reshaped the copper market. Inventory flows have shifted, physical conditions have tightened, and prices have moved back towards record highs.

Much of that repricing has already happened. Once the tariff decision is announced, the market's focus is likely to shift back to underlying fundamentals.

That would not necessarily change the broader outlook for copper. Any correction would be more likely to reflect a reassessment of tariff expectations than a deterioration in the underlying fundamentals.

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Article | 5 August 2026 SUSTAINABILITY

Global sustainable finance 2026: growth on the horizon

Resilient issuance keeps the global sustainable debt market on track for growth in 2026, despite geopolitical uncertainty, policy shifts and pockets of saturation. But the ingredients to the 'sustainable debt cocktail' are still changing, with some products and regions seeing stronger momentum

We expect the global sustainable debt market to grow in 2026 but we see divergences among regions and products

Growth set to return despite regional divergence

At the halfway mark of the year, we still expect the global sustainable finance market to return to growth for the full year, surpassing 2025 levels after a modest decline in 2025 from 2024.

Global sustainable debt issuance (excluding asset-backed securities, or ABS) totalled $846bn in the first half of 2026. Although this is a bit lower than the first-half issuances in 2025, it remains comfortably within the healthy $800bn-900bn range recorded in the first halves since 2022. That shows considerable market resilience, especially given the ongoing Middle East tensions and subdued sustainability policy environment in the US.

Looking at the full year of 2026, we expect resilience to yield growth, with the global sustainable finance market reaching $1,621bn of issuance. This will be driven by many factors:

- Middle East tensions make a stronger case for enhanced energy security, affordability,

and industrial competitiveness in Europe through clean energy buildout.
- The rush to build AI-driven data centres – and the growing scrutiny of their sustainability – is expected to drive sustainable debt issuance in the sector globally.
- The consequent need to enhance digital and power infrastructure to support AI development and electrification will spur sustainable financing.
- Many corporates remain committed to decarbonisation and managing climate risk.
- Governments are further leveraging sustainable finance as a tool to fund decarbonisation efforts.
- Regulation and standardisation provide clarity and ease.

Global sustainable debt issuance, historical and forecast

$bn

	Bonds					Loans					Total
	Green	Sustaina-bility	Social	Sust-linked	Transition	Green	Sustaina-bility	Social	Sust-linked	Transition	
2020	290.4	181.3	155.1	10.9	2.3	93.2	0.0	0.2	143.0	0.3	876.7
2021	601.6	249.3	237.2	109.2	3.8	117.8	4.7	0.1	530.1	0.1	1,853.8
2022	553.0	193.3	154.7	88.0	3.3	138.9	6.2	7.3	474.6	0.5	1,619.8
2023	611.7	202.5	155.9	70.0	2.8	164.6	12.4	4.4	244.4	0.6	1,469.3
2024	648.3	256.3	170.2	39.1	20.9	216.6	9.2	9.3	295.9	2.0	1,667.8
2025	669.2	271.5	138.6	33.3	11.7	247.8	19.4	8.5	139.5	0.0	1,539.4
2026F	*700.0*	*290.0*	*150.0*	*25.0*	*15.0*	*255.0*	*15.0*	*9.0*	*160.0*	*2.0*	*1,621.0*

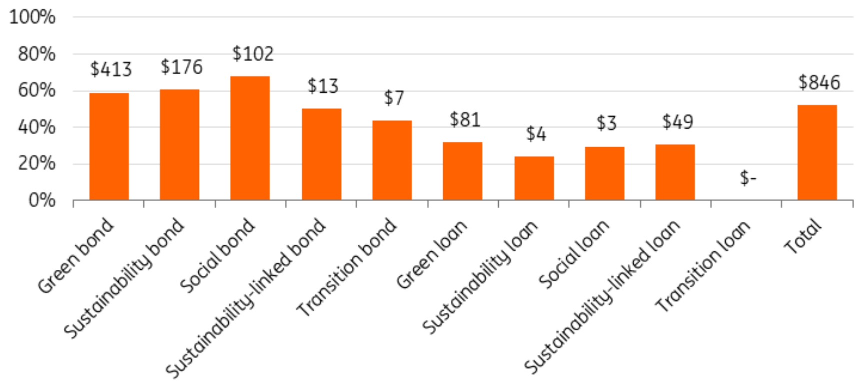
Source: ING Research, Bloomberg New Energy Finance (BloombergNEF). Note: Issuance data excludes asset-backed securities (ABS).

We stand by these forecasts for the year, as we already see most segments beyond the halfway point in terms of reaching these targets. The public market side, in particular, has 55-60% of the forecast already issued.

While the private market side appears to be lagging, we note that there may be some under-reporting within the private market side, and these figures may not reflect full issuance levels.

Global sustainable issuance in the first half of 2026 as a % of full-year forecast

$bn



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

Nevertheless, as noted in our market outlook in February, our expectations continue to vary across regions.

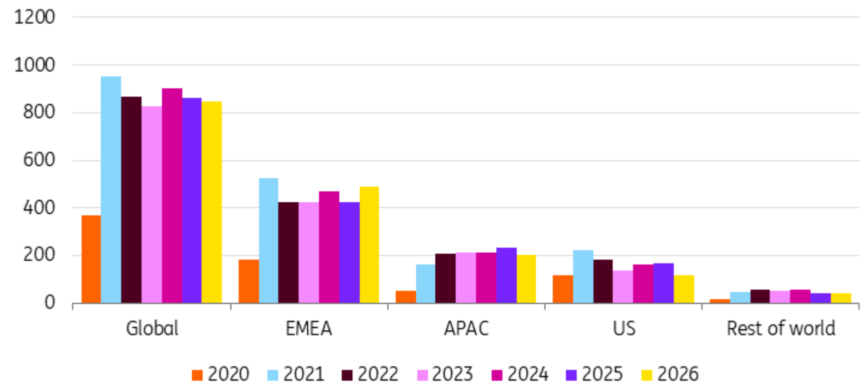
EMEA is leading sustainable debt issuance in 2026. Issuance in both the first and second quarters exceeded 2025 levels, driving a strong first half of the year. Much of this growth came from the public sector, with government agencies, sovereigns, and supranationals issuing a record $245bn in the first half – 50% higher than in 2025. Financial institutions also contributed to the momentum, increasing issuance by 36% year-over-year (YoY).

In **APAC**, issuance levels have been mostly steady over the past five years, despite first-half 2026 volumes being slightly lower than in 2025. That small dip is mainly due to softer issuance from financial institutions following a record first half in 2025. Even so, APAC is well positioned for growth, with both governments and companies continuing to advance decarbonisation goals through sustainable financing.

In the **US**, policy uncertainty continues to weigh on sustainable financing. First-half 2026 issuance was about 40% lower than in both 2024 and 2025, although it remained slightly above 2020 levels. Data centres, renewable energy, and related infrastructure have emerged as the engine of sustainable financing. We expect these sectors to maintain momentum through 2026 and 2027. For data centres, however, growing scrutiny of community impacts could lead to more selective, but ultimately higher-quality, sustainable debt issuance.

Sustainable debt issuance by region in the first half of each year

$bn



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

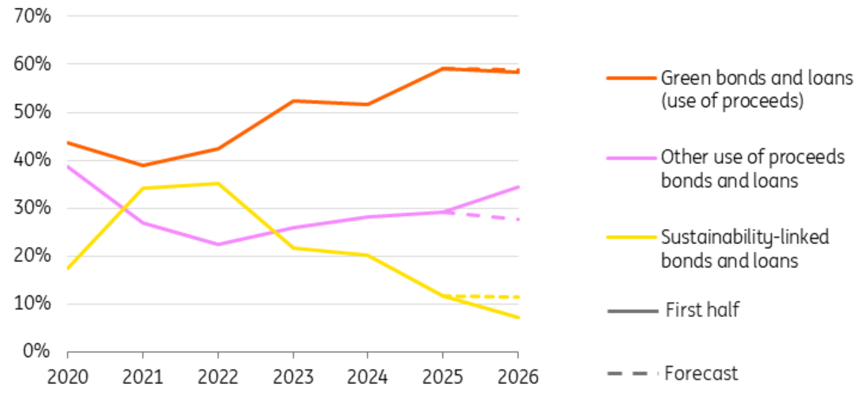
Green bonds and loans are still king

By product type, we expect green bonds and green loans to remain dominant in the global sustainable debt market, together accounting for around 60% of total issuance this year, up from 50% in 2024 and 40% in 2021. This reflects growing market preference for green use-of-proceeds instruments as credible tools for financing environmental projects.

Beyond green instruments, some other use-of-proceeds products, namely social bonds and sustainability bonds, also saw higher first-half issuances YoY, despite accounting for a much smaller market share.

Sustainability-linked bond and loan issuance remained under pressure in the first half of 2026, declining 54% YoY to just over $60bn. Their market share has fallen from 35% in 2022 to just over 10% in 2025, as issuers with green investment plans increasingly opt for green instruments. However, as noted in our previous outlook, sustainability-linked loan volumes are likely understated, as some private transactions may not be captured in sustainable debt databases. Despite accounting for only 7% of issuance in the first half of 2026, we expect the share of sustainability-linked debt to stabilise above 10% for the year.

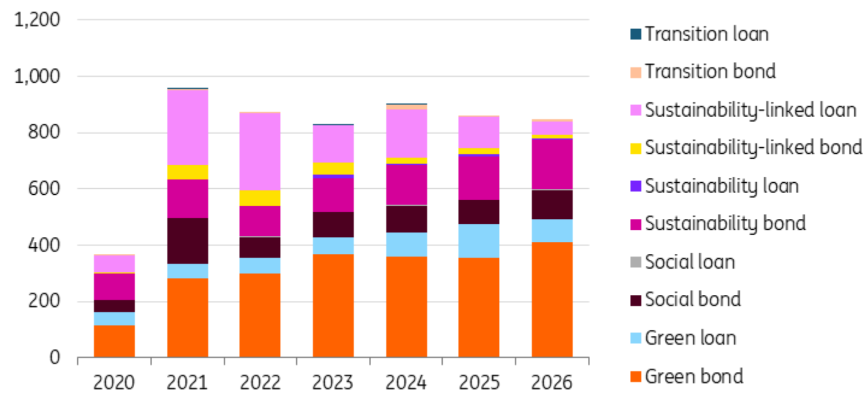
Share of sustainable debt products in total global issuance



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

Global sustainable debt issuance by product in the first half of each year

$bn



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

Corporates to remain soft as public issuances pick up

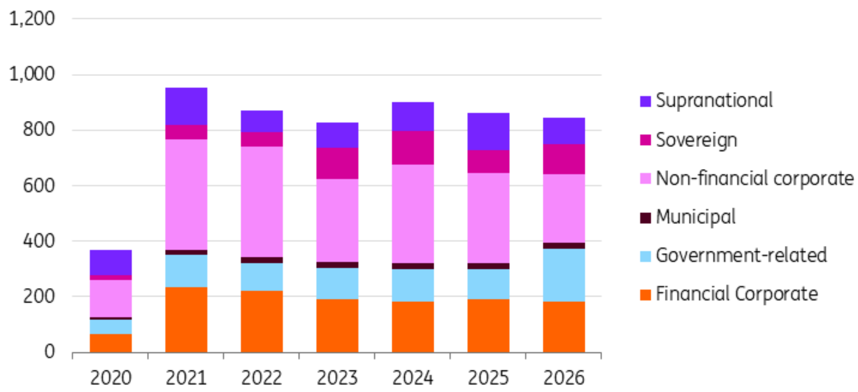
Issuances from non-financial corporates have continued to weaken in 2026. First-half issuance totalled $250bn, the lowest level since 2021. The slowdown was driven largely by weaker-than-expected issuance from European corporates, alongside an anticipated decline in the US amid policy uncertainty.

In Europe, the weakness may reflect a slightly saturated sustainable debt market, mixed with an environment of ease of issuance in general and a lack of economic benefit for going green (i.e. no 'greenium' at this time). This is temporary, as, historically in times of higher volatility within markets, it's the sustainable bond products that outperform and hold firmer. Naturally, standardisation will continue to keep sustainable issuance effort-free, and the likes of the Green Bond Standard, while not intended to be adopted by all issuers, continue to drive high-quality issuance.

In contrast, issuances from government agencies rose 73% YoY in the first half of 2026. The biggest contributor to that increase is a record $58bn of issuance from German state-owned investment and development bank KfW, with its second-highest first-half issuance being $25bn. The bank has an ambition of investing in competitiveness through environmental action. In APAC, governments in Australia and Mainland China also saw issuance increases.

Global sustainable debt issuance by issuer type in the first half of each year

$bn



Source: ING Research, BloombergNEF. Note: Issuance data excludes ABS.

For the rest of 2026, we expect the public sector to be the primary driver of global sustainable debt issuance. Corporate issuance is likely to remain soft and end the year below 2025 levels. However, corporates still have significant sustainable financing needs, as strategic segments such as AI data centres, digitalisation, innovation, and critical infrastructure will increasingly demand energy efficiency and decarbonisation.

There would also be growing regulatory and stakeholder focus on data centre sustainability. The EU is mandating energy reporting and green financing rules for data centres, while actively developing performance standards and efficiency labels. In the US, growing scrutiny of data centres' environmental footprint could lead to a more disciplined approach to sustainable finance.

Conclusion

We expect global sustainable debt issuance to stay relatively strong throughout 2026, supporting our forecast for a return to market growth this year. However, regional, product and issuer dynamics continue to diverge. The sustainable debt cocktail is poised to get bigger, but its ingredients are still evolving.

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Article | 4 August 2026 TMT

Webinar: The AI race - who will fund and fuel the next wave?

AI is becoming one of the biggest investment, infrastructure and energy stories of our time. Join us to explore how the AI boom is being financed, what investors are watching, and whether power systems can keep pace with soaring demand. Sign up here

AI is no longer just a technology story. As investment and power needs surge, it has become a capital markets, infrastructure and energy story, too. The race to build AI capabilities is driving unprecedented spending on data centres, compute capacity and power infrastructure. This raises important questions for investors, policymakers and industry leaders.

In this webinar, we will explore how AI expansion is being financed, how investors are assessing the opportunity, and how energy systems can keep pace with growing demand.

You'll learn:

- Why accelerating data centre investment can remain sustainable
- What investors are watching across the largest technology companies
- How AI is reshaping capital markets and financing needs
- How data centres are transforming energy systems and local economies
- How power infrastructure can keep pace — and at what cost

Click here to sign up

Details

Date: Thursday 13 August

Time: 1400 BST/1500 CEST/0900 ET

The webinar will last 30 minutes, including Q&A.

The event will take place online and the waiting room will open 60 minutes ahead of the scheduled start time.

A joining link will be emailed following registration, and you will receive a reminder email 10 minutes before the scheduled start time.

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